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For over five decades, Pinakin Patel has been one of India's most influential yet quietly radical design voices. The renowned architect, interior designer, furniture designer and fashion designer, whose ongoing retrospective at Mumbai's Nilaya Anthology (till March 31) celebrates his life and work, refrains from retrospection. "I have lived life so intensely, with each moment being a search for a new discipline, new meaning and new philosophy, coupled with the prolific nature of my work, that there was hardly any time to revisit anything," he shares. He acknowledges, though, that it is often failure that leads one to retrospect. "At the risk of sounding pompous, it has been a continuously upward journey. So, I never felt the need to retrospect. I'm still Alice in Wonderland!" he laughs.

Conceived as an immersive, multimedia experience, *The Turning Point* offers an expansive view of a creative life that has shaped India's contemporary design language in profound ways. The showcase includes a film as well as a limited-edition publication on Patel, 11 seminal works and 19 curated objects from his expansive personal collection and also select works from the Dashrath Patel archive. The latter being an ode to his guru, the founder-director of education at the National Institute of Design Ahmedabad, this one remains special to Patel. "There is a sense of history flowing down from Dashrath to me and also in a way, revealing the visual history of art and design from the 1940s till now," he shares.

Patel's journey into the creative disciplines was not so much a choice as a calling. After studying chemistry so as to join his family business, he realised that he wasn't cut out for it. "I wanted to do something creative, but there wasn't a clean-cut direction because no one in the family had practised any aspects of the arts," he recalls. Although the term sabbatical wasn't popularised during the '70s, that is what he took, realising that he was too young to keep compromising on his dreams. After speaking to the two women in his life—his mother and his wife—he decided to leave the family business and reinvent himself as a designer.

Impressed by his designs on lamps, photo frames and other objects of home décor, five-star hotels became some of his first buyers. In 1984, he opened Etcetera, one of India's first lifestyle stores. After that, it was a series of organic events that led him to become an



CRAFT WORK
A burl armchair, a kilim sideboard and a contour sofa from the Pinakin Studio

ART ▼

PAST THE DIGITAL BLUR

An **INTERNATIONAL EXHIBITION** in Delhi reimagines what it means to be human today

In an era when faces are mapped by algorithms, the question that arises is, where does the body end and the machine begin? Delving further into the porous boundaries between bodies, machines and public space is an ambitious, two-site international exhibition in Delhi titled *Are You Human?* by Khoj International Artists' Association. Presented at Khoj Studios and DLF Avenue Mall, Saket, for a public viewing, the exhibition brings together Indian and international artists to interrogate how technology reshapes identity, intimacy, and everyday life.

Pooja Sood, director, Khoj International Artists' Association, says that in a moment shaped by AI, deepfakes and immersive media, it is critical to create spaces for dialogue that ask deeper questions about power, bias, authorship and agency. "What excites me about this exhibition is its ability to hold complexity—addressing both the anxieties and possibilities of technological change—and to foreground artistic practice as a vital site for reflection, resistance and reimagining what it means to be human today," she says.

Some artists and collaborators include Anisha Baid (India), Ars Electronica Animation on Tour (Austria), Ben Andrews & Emma Roberts (Australia),